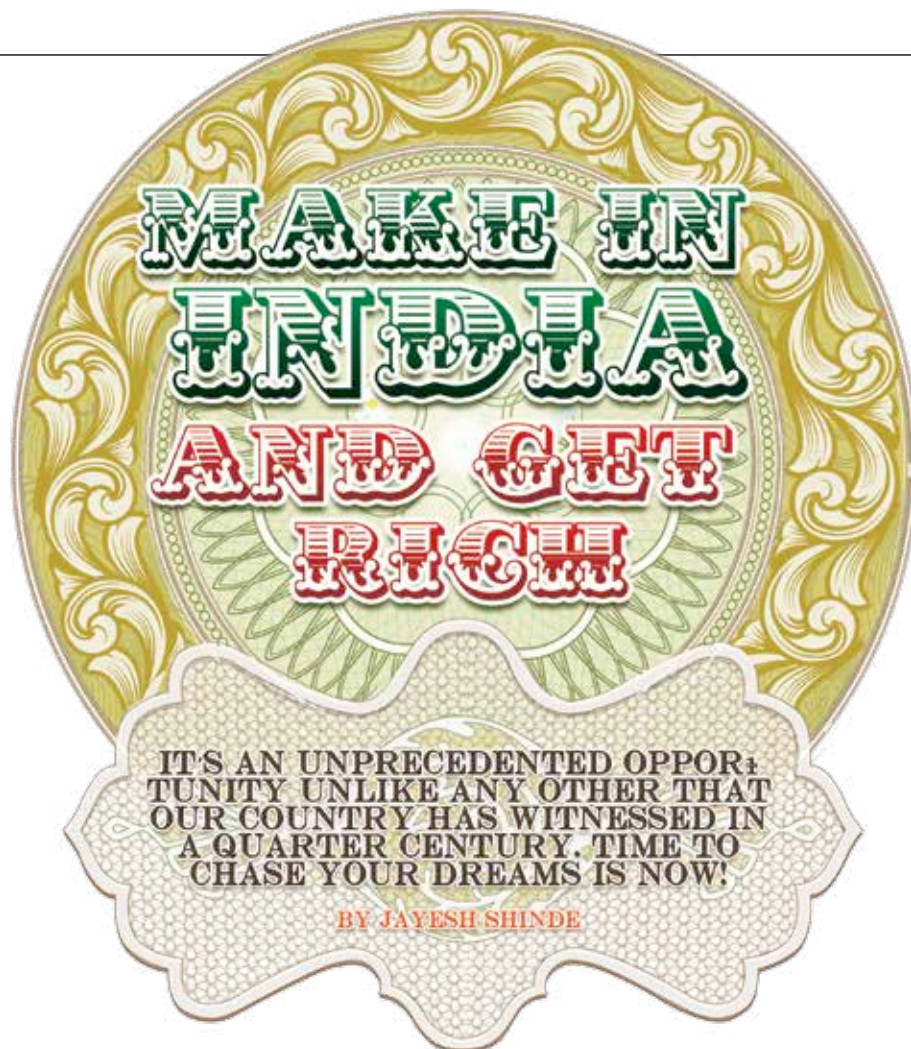




lot has been written about the government's vision of putting India at the centre stage of global manufacturing. However, we feel innovations in not just manufacturing but also technology, and its myriad applications to help solve real-world problems, are what will govern future success stories.

SOLVE A REAL PROBLEM

Justdial started with a seed capital of ₹50,000 back in 1996 at a small rented apartment in Mumbai's suburbs. It currently employs over 7,500 employees, generating hundreds of crores of revenue. It has Amitabh Bachchan as its brand ambassador and sponsors several IPL teams. Not bad for a company that at one time couldn't even afford its popular (022) 8888888 number's ₹15,000 monthly phone bill? At a time when people didn't have access to Google (which is still a large part of India), Justdial offered people a phone-based search engine, since almost everyone had a phone.

Sabeer Bhatia did something similar back when he launched Hotmail.com in

July 1996. Not only did it become wildly popular as a free email service at the time, it still continues to have the second largest email subscriber base in the world at 369 million after Google's Gmail.

The Bansals at Flipkart did something similar when they founded their e-commerce portal back in 2007, which proved to be a pivotal moment that catalysed the entire online shopping phenomenon in India. Its launch led to an avalanche of e-commerce websites launching in the country, transforming the e-shopping landscape permanently.

Why do you think these companies succeeded? Because all of them solved real problems that people cared about and appreciated. We don't need jugaad, we need true innovation, like Justdial, Hotmail and Flipkart delivered. That's the quickest way to success and, of course, making money.

Through Make in India, everyone who solves an existing problem better than anyone else, stands to empower the citizens of our country, and in that process stands to make a killing!

EMPOWER PEOPLE THROUGH TECHNOLOGY

India's social divide, the gap between the rich and the poor, can be effectively bridged if we try to bridge the digital divide. Here are a few examples of companies trying to empower people by exposing them to technology tools:

Tata Trusts and Google India recently announced the launch of a special program called "Internet Saathi" to empower women and deprived communities in rural India by enabling them to use the Internet and benefit from it in their daily lives. The joint initiative is aimed at bridging the technology gender divide, which currently puts women in rural India at further risk of getting marginalised in society. The initiative will provide basic training on the usage and benefits of Internet for women through specially designed Internet cycle carts which will not only be used for locomotion but allow women easy access to Internet.

The operator, or the "Internet Saathi", who will train the women, will be akin to the village postman – who was the single